

■ El Niño Watch

Under the condition that El Niño is developing,

an alert is issued when conditions are favorable for the development of El Niño within the next 3-4 months with chance greater than or equal to 50%. One of the following criteria needs to be satisfied :

- Observation: SSTA¹⁾ greater than or equal to 0.5°C and ONI²⁾ between -0.5°C and 0.5°C in the latest month
- Prediction: SSTA greater than or equal to 0.5°C for 2 months out of the next 4 months, or chance³⁾ of El Niño development greater than or equal to 50% for the next 3 months

■ El Niño Alert

Under the condition that El Niño is developing,

an alert is issued when conditions are favorable for the development of El Niño within the next 3-4 months with chance greater than or equal to 60%. All of the following criteria need to be satisfied :

- Observation: SSTA greater than or equal to 0.5°C in the latest 2 months, and ONI greater than or equal to 0.5 °C in the latest month
- Prediction: ONI greater than or equal to 0.5°C for the next 2 months, or chance of El Niño development greater than or equal to 60% for the next 3 months

■ El Niño

Under the condition that El Niño is developing,

an alert is issued when El Niño is nearly developed and expected to persist in the next 3 months.

All of the following criteria need to be satisfied :

- Observation: SSTA greater than or equal to 0.5°C in the latest 2 months, and ONI greater than or equal to 0.5 °C in the latest month
- Prediction: ONI greater than or equal to 0.5°C for the next 3 months

However, if El Niño is in its decaying phase, ONI in the latest month is greater than or equal to 0.5 °C, while the conditions for “El Niño watch” or “El Niño alert” are satisfied, the alert is concluded as “El Niño”

■ Inactive

No favorable conditions to exceed El Niño/La Niña warning criteria within the next 3-5 months

La Niña Watch

Under the condition that La Niña is developing,

an alert is issued when conditions are favorable for the development of La Niña within the next 3-4 months with chance greater than or equal to 50%. One of the following criteria needs to be satisfied :

- Observation: SSTA less than or equal to -0.5°C and ONI between -0.5°C and 0.5°C in the latest month
- Prediction: SSTA less than or equal to 0.5°C for 2 months out of the next 4 months, or chance of La Niña development greater than or equal to 50% for the next 3 months

La Niña Alert

Under the condition that La Niña is developing,

an alert is issued when conditions are favorable for the development of La Niña within the next 3-4 months with chance greater than or equal to 60%. All of the following criteria need to be satisfied :

- Observation: SSTA less than or equal to -0.5°C in the latest 2 months, and ONI less than or equal to -0.5°C in the latest month
- Prediction: ONI less than or equal to -0.5°C for the next 2 months, or chance of La Niña development greater than or equal to 60% for the next 3 months

La Niña

Under the condition that La Niña is developing,

an alert is issued when La Niña is nearly developed and expected to persist in the next 3 months. All of the following criteria need to be satisfied :

- Observation: SSTA less than or equal to -0.5°C in the latest 2 months, and ONI less than or equal to -0.5°C in the latest month
- Prediction: ONI less than or equal to -0.5°C for the next 3 months

However, if La Niña is in its decaying phase, ONI in the latest month is less than or equal to -0.5°C , while the conditions for “La Niña watch” or “La Niña alert” are satisfied, the alert is concluded as “La Niña”

1) SSTA : Sea Surface Temperature Anomaly at the Nino 3.4 region ($5^{\circ}\text{N}\sim 5^{\circ}\text{S}$, $120^{\circ}\text{W}\sim 170^{\circ}\text{W}$)

2) ONI : Oceanic Nino Index; defined as the 3-month running mean average Nino 3.4 index

3) ENSO probability based on APCC MME probabilistic forecast issued every month